

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 5
 ♥ 9 7 4 2
 ♦ 8 6 2
 ♣ 7 6 5 2

♠ K 9 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ Q J 3

♣ A K 9



♠ A Q J 2

♥ J 10 3

♦ A K 10

♣ J 10 3

♠ 10 3

♥ K Q 8 5

♦ 9 7 5 4

♣ Q 8 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by South

has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that South has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

[showcards W:S5]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. The 2♥ bid was a transfer. The 5NT bid meant to choose either 6♠ or 6NT. South liked the suit. Partner led the ♠5, won by South's ♠Q. South pulls one more trump with his ♠A, then wins three high ♦s. Next comes dummy's ♥A on which he plays the ♥3 and West plays the ♥9. Then he leads dummy's ♥6 which you win with the ♥Q. On this trick South drops the ♥J and West the ♥2. It is your play.

Play the ♥K.

If you believe South is now out of ♥s then you should not play your ♥K because it would give him a ruff-sluff.

But you shouldn't believe South when your partner has sent you a clear signal that he holds an EVEN number of ♥s. In this case an even number must be 4 which means that South has one more ♥. So you play your ♥K. He ruffs in dummy of course, but then has no way to get rid of that ♣ loser when the finesse fails.

If you had not been paying attention to West's signal you might have decided to risk a ♣ lead - with a disastrous result.

Board 2

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q 10

♥ 9 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ A K 10 6 3

♠ 6 4

♥ A J 8

♦ A Q J 6

♣ 8 7 5 4



♠ 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 9 7 4 3

♣ Q 2

♠ K J 3

♥ K Q 7 6 4 3

♦ K 10

♣ J 9

West

1 ♣

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by South
ruff.*North*

Pass

2 ♣

East

Pass

Pass

South

1 ♥

4 ♥

[showcards W:CA E:C2 S:C9 N:C4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♣A, East played the ♣2 and South the ♣9. What should you play to the second trick?

Play the ♣6.

On first thought East's ♣2 seems to be a discouraging signal. Think again.

After the first trick you know the location of every ♣ except the ♣Q and ♣J. If East started with ♣J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣J. If East started with ♣Q J 2 he would have signaled with the ♣Q. Since he did neither he started either with singleton ♣2 or with ♣Q 2. In either case you should play a low ♣ now which he will either win with his ♣Q or he will

It turns out that he wins with the ♣Q, then leads a ♠ back to your ♠ A Q.